

AI Intake Triage — what it does and how to use it

For intake staff and paralegals · Version 1 · Owner: Gerardo Ramírez

What this does

When a new intake arrives — a voicemail transcript, a website form, or a referral e-mail — you submit it through the **New intake** Google Form (paste the text or upload the file). Within a minute the assistant does three things:

- 1 **Pulls out the key facts** — who the potential client is, how to reach the contact, the facility, the date, the injury, how they found us, and how urgent it looks — and, for every fact, records the exact words in the original where it found it.
- 2 **Writes a five-sentence summary** an attorney can read in twenty seconds.
- 3 **Adds a row** to the **Intake Review Queue** sheet with a colour-coded status.

It does not call anyone, does not open a matter, and never deletes the original text (it is in the `source_text` column, and the file you uploaded stays in Drive).

The three statuses

Status	Meaning	What you do
READY FOR ATTORNEY REVIEW	All core facts (who, how to reach them, where, what injury) were found and verified.	Read the summary, check the urgency, forward to the attorney.
NEEDS FOLLOW-UP	Something essential is missing or could not be verified. You also get an e-mail.	<code>missing_fields</code> says what to ask; <code>contact_name</code> / <code>contact_phone</code> say whom. Make the call, then resubmit the intake with the new information (the row updates itself).
PIPELINE ERROR	The assistant could not process this intake at all. You also get an e-mail.	Handle the intake by hand, as you do today, and report it (see below).

A **HIGH** urgency also sends an e-mail even when the row is green — that means “look today”, not “the AI decided”.

When to trust it

- A fact is trustworthy when it has a **source quote** next to it (open `record_json` at the far right, or click the cell). The assistant is built so that any fact **without** an exact quote from the original is thrown away and replaced with **NOT FOUND**.
- So **NOT FOUND is honest, not broken**. It means “the intake did not say this”, and it is your cue to ask.
- The warnings column says none when every check passed. Anything else is a note about something the assistant refused to guess.

When NOT to trust it

- **Urgency is a suggestion**. **HIGH** means look now; **LOW** never means ignore. The reason is in `urgency_reason`; judge it yourself.
- **Dates are kept as words**. “Right after Easter” stays exactly that; the assistant will not turn it into a calendar date. You do.
- **Labels can be a reading, not a copy**. “Referring attorney” next to a quote that says “I’m referring a matter” is a reasonable interpretation, verified as to where it came from — not a fact the caller stated.
- **Never act on the summary alone**. Before you call a client, open a matter, or decline a case, read the original text. It is one click away.
- Messy voicemails can confuse **who is the caller and who is the injured person**. Double-check before you address someone.

When it breaks

Signs: a red row, rows that stop appearing after you submit, a fact with no quote, a summary that is not five sentences, or an e-mail with empty fields.

- 1 Process the intake manually, as you do today. Nothing is lost — the original is in the sheet, in Drive, and in your inbox.
- 2 Tell **Gerardo Ramírez** (workflow owner) with the **intake_id** from the sheet (or the time you submitted), what you expected, and a screenshot.
- 3 Do not edit the workflow yourself. If the owner is unavailable, keep working manually; the queue will catch up when the assistant is back.

Synthetic data only during evaluation. Costs about 1.5 cents per intake.